- Unripe bananas and apples should not be given as they are difficult to chew and may choke the child.
- Candies and sweets should be in moderation. Foods like tea and coffee should not be given as they are more stimulating to the system.
- Foods should be seasoned so that they taste better and the child takes it well.
- Fried foods and concentrated foods should not be given as they are difficult to digest.
- The Child should never be forced to eat more than what he can take and the atmosphere should be peaceful, pleasant and lacking distraction.
- People feeding the child should not show dislike of any food in front of the child; this may lead to the rejection of the food by the child.
- Regularity of meals is essential.
- Food preferences of the child should be taken into consideration.

Nutritional Problems among Pre-Schoolers

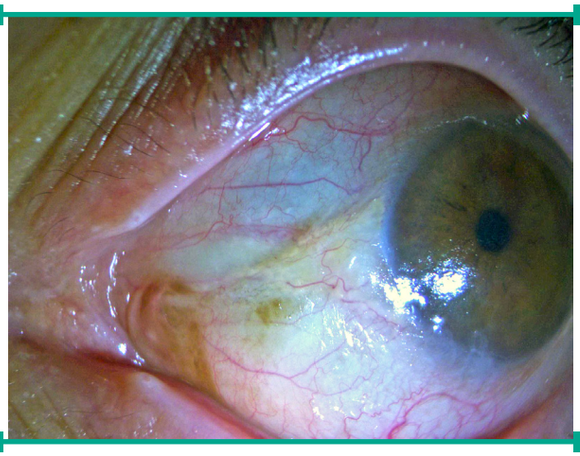
Protein-Energy Malnutrition (PEM)

The primary cause of malnutrition is a faulty and inadequate diet. Besides diet and socioeconomic factors, various environmental factors aggravate the dietary deficiencies. These include chronic infection, poor environmental sanitation, poor insanitary living conditions and poor personal hygiene. The diseases that represent extreme forms of PEM are

i. Kwashiorkor
ii. Marasmus, and
iii. *Marasmic Kwashiorkor*

Vitamin-A deficiency

Inadequate dietary intake of vitamin A or its precursor (β-carotene) is exhibited as



▲ Fig 2 Bitot's spot



▲ Fig 3 Keratomalacia

Nutritional Needs during School Age (6-12 Years)

Bitot's spots, kertomalacia in preschool children.

The school-age, six to twelve years, has been called the latent time of growth. The rate of growth slows down and body changes occur gradually. The slow rate of growth during this period result in a gradual decline in food requirement per unit of body weight.

Energy

Energy needs vary with growth rate, body size and physical activity. The requirement **for calories** increases during school age.

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